Zara Khan

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Education

University of California, Berkeley -- Haas School of Business Berkeley, CA
B.S. Business Administration, Spieker Undergraduate Business Program

Polytechnic School Pasadena, CA
Unweighted GPA: 3.7 | Weighted GPA: 4.1

Experience

Polytechnic School (PolySummer Program) Pasadena, CA
Teaching Assistant June 2025 - July 2025
June 2026 - July 2026

- Supported instruction across math, business, art courses for elementary and middle school students
- Assisted students with coursework and organization in accelerated academic settings
- Collaborated with teachers to facilitate group instruction and individualized academic support
- Supervised student carline transitions, ensuring safety and smooth movement between classes

Davalan Produce Los Angeles, CA
Finance Intern June 2025 - August 2025

- Analyzed operational and financial data to track costs and inventory efficiency
- Supported accounting workflows including expense categorization and financial reporting
- Evaluated pricing structures and supplier data to identify opportunities for cost optimization

ACEing Autism Pasadena and Los Angeles, CA
Volunteer Coach October 2022 - August 2026

- Provide individualized tennis instruction to children with autism; adapted drills to meet sensory + motor needs
- Small-group sessions: reinforced routines, modeled social interaction
- Collaborate with coaches + caregivers; align instruction with child's goals + comfort level

Leadership & Activities

Kash-Zen Financial Literacy Initiative Pasadena, CA
Founder & Director January 2024 - June 2026

- Founded and led financial club literacy for immigrants, re-entry populations, underserved high-schoolers
- Designed and delivered bilingual curricula covering budgeting, banking systems, credit, decision-making
- Built and maintained community partnerships with local organizations: Learning Works, the International Institute of Los Angeles, the Boys & Girls Club, Wahoo Kids, CollegeMatch LA
- Recruited and trained student instructors and volunteers; oversaw logistics and outreach
- Led workshop facilitation and curriculum refinement based on feedback

Peer Mentor Program Polytechnic School, Pasadena, CA
Peer Mentor May 2025 - June 2026

- Selected as 1 of 10 seniors to mentor ninth-grade students transitioning into Upper School
- Led high school freshmen advisory group 1-2 times per week
- Focused meetings on academic organization, social adjustment, overall well-being
- Built trust-based relationships through consistent check-ins + ongoing mentorship

Middle Eastern Affinity Group & **Muslim Student Union** Polytechnic School, Pasadena, CA
Student Leader August 2022 - June 2026

- Held leadership roles in two distinct student organizations: Middle Eastern Affinity Group and Muslim Student Union. Focus on cultural identity and community education
- Planned and organized discussions and events addressing history, religion, contemporary global issues
- Organized community-building programming (e.g. food/dance events); foster belonging & cultural celebration
- Coordinated annual Ramadan iftar celebrations; brought together school community members
- Advocated for + helped establish dedicated prayer space in Upper School
- Initiated and helped lead cross-affinity dialogue with Jewish Student Union following events of October 7

Upper School Student Community Engagement Council (USSCEC) Polytechnic School, Pasadena, CA
Student Representative May 2024 - June 2026

- Served on council dedicated to service learning; collaborated with student club leaders, ASB, teachers, administrators, and program director to strengthen school-wide community engagement initiatives
- Coordinated and promoted engagement opportunities through assembly, bulletins, MyPoly, admissions events
- Tracked "Significant Experiences" (MobileServe); ensured students' accurate documentation of engagement for high-school volunteering requirements
- "Buddy" to underclassmen; personalized guidance on service opportunities & ethical community engagement
- Bi-weekly council meetings + subcommittees; spearheaded event planning + follow-up coordination

Polytechnic School Alumni Board Polytechnic School, Pasadena, CA
Student Representative (Junior & Senior Years) May 2024 - June 2026

- Selected as sole student representative school-wide for two-year appointment; represent Upper School at Alumni Board level
- Primary bridge between current students and the Alumni Association
- Translated student needs into alumni programming and opportunities
- Actively advance alumni-student engagement initiatives (PolyConnect, Distinguished Alumni Visiting Day, Alumni Roundtable) through Morning Meetings and school-wide communications
- Attended monthly Board meetings; presented updates on student life; contributed to alumni engagement strategy

SLIDE (Student Leadership for Inclusion, Diversity and Equity) Polytechnic School, Pasadena, CA
Student Leader May 2024 - June 2026

- Selected as 1 of 9 students to serve solution-oriented council; worked with Poly's DEI Director to advance belonging
- Collaborated with affinity group leaders and faculty to amplify student perspectives
- Helped plan + execute school-wide programming, including SLIDEshow events, individual affinity group events, school-wide assemblies (Lunar New Year, Holi, Black History Month, etc.)
- "30 Seconds with SLIDE" weekly announcements during assemblies; highlight DEI initiatives and events

GIP Program (Global Initiatives Program) Polytechnic School, Pasadena, CA
Global Scholar January 2025 - June 2026

- Selected for interdisciplinary global studies program focused on contemporary political and social issues
- Completed two 2-week cultural immersion programs in Japan (June 2025) and France (March 2026)
- Researched + published monthly analytical blog posts on current global issues, with focus on economics
- Attended and engaged weekly guest speakers and experts on global affairs
- Hosted + moderated Pasadena community forum with Jared S. Franz, Ph.D., Partner and U.S. Economist at Capital Group; explored AI's impact on markets + future of global economy
- Completed capstone research on economic + environmental impacts of LA wildfires + potential policy responses

Teens at the Door Pasadena Chapter Pasadena, CA
Director January 2023 - June 2026

- Designed and led student-run workshops supporting Afghan and Ukrainian refugees navigating transitions
- Worked in partnership with International Institute of Los Angeles (IILA) to align programming with refugee needs
- Planned and facilitated interactive, relationship-based activities & discussions; forwarded trust + cultural exchange
- Coordinated bi-weekly planning meetings, generating programming ideas and preparing workshop materials

Awards

- PolyGlobal's Global Scholar Certificate 2026 (Polytechnic School), AP Scholar with Distinction 2025 (College Board), Paws for Humanity Grant recipient 2025 (Polytechnic School), Super Teachers Assistant Award 2025 (PolySummer)

Skills & Interests

- Technical + Data: Python, Java, RStudio (dplyr, ggplot2), Microsoft Excel, statistical analysis, data visualization
- Business: Financial literacy, budgeting, basic accounting, cost and pricing analysis
- Productivity: Google Workspace, Canva, presentation and curriculum design
- Leadership + Communication: Public speaking, program development, community partnership coordination, cross-cultural communication, community outreach, affinity-group leadership
- Languages: English (native), Urdu (fluent), French (fluent), Spanish (advanced)
- Interests: Personal Finance, Consumer Psychology, Visual Arts, Fitness, Cooking, Travel, Music & Playlists, Driving, Cats